THE PRODUCT POINT OF VIEW

Discover your customer’s next growth opportunity.

SalesPlay, reimagined around a useful customer decision: what could they win, what stands in the way, and where can your solution help?

THE PRODUCT BET

MarketsandMarkets’ granular research and analyst expertise could help sellers connect market changes to specific customer growth opportunities - earlier and more precisely. The advantage must be demonstrated, not assumed.

The seller’s job.

Jamie Shah, a technical enterprise seller at fictional Aster Automation, needs to find accounts where robotic core stacking could help. The product should reveal a relevant customer opportunity, make the reasoning inspectable, and prepare a practical validation conversation.

Change the starting point.

Move from “Which account should I pitch?” to “Which customer opportunity can I help make achievable?” Start with the business the buyer could serve; work back through its constraints to the seller’s contribution.

- **Discover.** Surface Ridgeway Transformers outside Jamie’s existing account list through a segment-to-process connection.
- **Quantify.** Build an editable capacity case that distinguishes added machine capacity from useful factory output.
- **Change course.** When the buyer corrects testing capacity, remove the modeled output benefit and update the next conversation.

Evidence boundary: Independent interview concept based on the supplied assignment summary and public sources. All sellers, accounts, research samples, buyer updates, and economics are fictional. No proprietary research or customer interviews were available.

COMPETITIVE BASELINE

Opportunity discovery is already part of the category.

The concept must earn its differentiation through the quality of the customer decision. Public vendor materials establish positioning; they do not establish comparative performance.

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EXISTING PRODUCT

SalesPlay already describes opportunity discovery, offering-to-initiative matching, buying centers, and business cases. This proposal sharpens that direction into an inspectable workflow; it does not claim those capabilities are absent. [S1]

Product / source	Public positioning	Implication
Kris@Work [S2]	A broad AI-native GTM workflow spanning prospecting and deal execution.	Choose a focused entry point; avoid recreating the whole revenue stack.
6sense [S3]	Explainable account prioritization and suggested next actions.	An explained ranking alone is not a sufficient advantage.
Clay [S4]	Account research agents with structured outputs and business context.	Auditable research can be reproduced; specialist relevance must earn its value.
Apollo [S5]	Signals, business context, and research-to-action orchestration.	Workflow automation is expected; measure decision usefulness.
Gong [S6]	Customer interaction context supporting revenue intelligence.	Complement the seller's conversations with external demand mechanisms.

The differentiation to test.

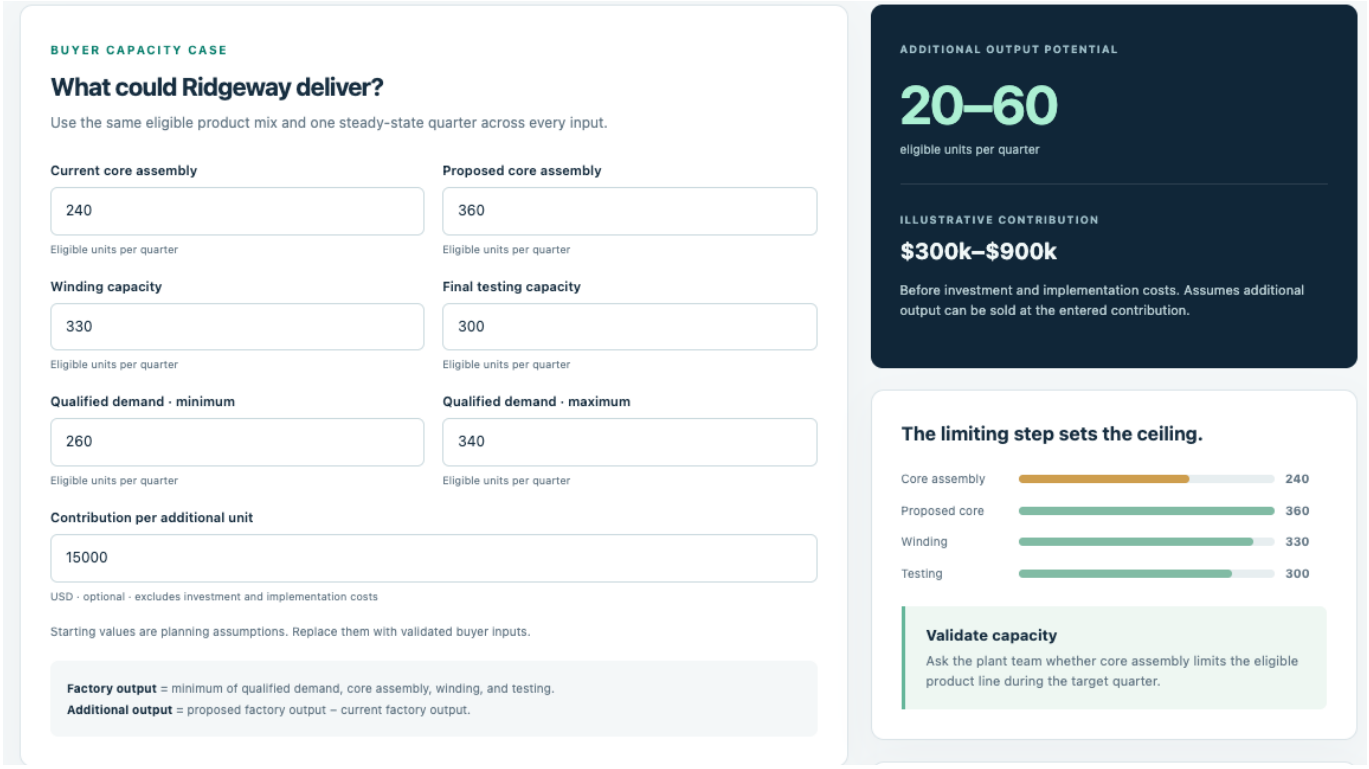
Can entitled segment intelligence, maintained market relationships, and analyst judgment produce more useful, specific, correct opportunities than the same model and workflow using public information?

No hands-on competitor benchmark was performed. Feature availability and commercial claims were not independently verified. References and access dates appear on page 7.

THE CUSTOMER JOURNEY

One opportunity. Five connected decisions.

Jamie sells robotic stacking for laminated cores. Ridgeway may fit; HarborGrid is already known; Summit's wound-core process is excluded.



Interactive capacity case: buyer-editable inputs and a calculation constrained by the entire modeled production line.

Stage	Decision the product supports
1. Discover	Why is Ridgeway newly relevant, given the seller's actual capabilities?
2. Explain	Which connections link the market change to the customer's opportunity?
3. Build the case	How much additional deliverable output could the buyer achieve under stated assumptions?
4. Validate	Which missing fact could overturn the case, and who can resolve it?
5. Prepare	What useful next conversation follows from the current evidence?

Production-minded interaction: concise seller copy, source details on demand, review before use, and no unsupported purchase probabilities. A separate product-thinking section carries the interview explanation.

THE POTENTIAL MOAT

Turn specialist intelligence into a maintained decision advantage.

A research library is valuable input. The product must turn it into better decisions that remain useful when the customer challenges the assumptions.

Potential asset [S7]	Product capability	Dependency to verify
Granular segment research	Find relevant product, application, geography, and delivery conditions.	Coverage, freshness, licensing, and useful segment granularity.
Market interconnections	Connect demand formation to process needs and seller capabilities.	Structured, sourced relationships with applicability limits.
Analyst expertise	Resolve industry questions and review bounded mechanisms.	A repeatable review process with sustainable response time and cost.
Dated research and validation	Re-use applicable findings and learn which mechanisms produce buyer-confirmed needs.	Rights, expiry, outcome quality, and governance.

Make the contribution visible.

The “What research adds” comparison holds seller and account context constant. Public evidence provides the industry backdrop; simulated specialist records add segment exclusions, process conditions, and validation routes. No artificial numerical research uplift is claimed.

PROVE THE MOAT WITH AN ABLATION

Compare public-only research against public research plus entitled MarketsandMarkets intelligence, using the same model and workflow. Blind reviewers assess useful novelty, specificity, correctness, and buyer-confirmed need. If results are equivalent, the claimed research advantage is unproven.

KnowledgeStore publicly positions analyst-curated proprietary data and market interconnections [S7]. This concept does not verify an existing API, account-level graph, or availability of the simulated records used here.

FEASIBLE ARCHITECTURE

Use explicit rules for the case. Constrain AI with evidence.

The local prototype demonstrates the behavior. A real first product can begin with one vertical, a small account set, and manually curated relationships.

PROPOSED FIRST-PRODUCT FLOW

Seller capabilities + entitled research + account context → scoped demand mechanism → opportunity hypothesis → buyer capacity case → targeted validation → seller-reviewed conversation.

A transparent capacity model.

For one eligible product mix in one steady-state quarter: output = minimum of qualified demand, core assembly, winding, and testing. Additional output = proposed output minus current output. Unknown required inputs produce an incomplete case.

Illustrative input	Initial case	Buyer correction
Core assembly / proposed	240 / 360	240 / 360
Winding / testing	330 / 300	330 / 220
Qualified demand	260-340	260-340
Additional output	20-60 units	0 units
Contribution at $15k/unit	$300k-$900k before costs	$0 modeled output contribution

- **Evidence and AI.** Store rights, source dates, applicability, claim type, and conflicts. Retrieve relevant material and generate a structured brief grounded in it. An analyst cannot supply invented private plant or budget facts.
- **Revision-aware actions.** Any relevant evidence or case change clears draft review and marks saved briefs stale. Editing text also clears review. A fresh review is required before saving or exporting a conversation brief.

Implemented here: static HTML/CSS/JavaScript; structured fixtures; pure calculation rules; local browser storage; offline standalone edition. No live AI, CRM, email, or proprietary data access. The calculation excludes ramp, costs, other constraints, and quality effects; it is not an ROI or factory simulation.

VALIDATION AND PRESENTATION

Measure useful opportunities, not persuasive narratives.

The following studies, thresholds, and rollout stages are proposals. No customer research results, conversion lift, or research advantage are claimed.

Discover and test comprehension.

Reconstruct recent decisions with 6-8 technical sellers and 2-3 sales leaders. Then test the prototype with 5 sellers. Ask them to explain why Ridgeway surfaced, identify the critical unknown, change the case, and explain why the proposal should wait. Proposed usability gate: 4 of 5 complete this without assistance.

Run a narrow, directional pilot.

Use a 4-6 week pilot in one vertical. Keep model and workflow constant while comparing research inputs on matched opportunity sets. Blind reviewers score novelty, specificity, correctness, and usefulness. Log all surfaced and rejected opportunities, prior account knowledge, research time, and analyst effort.

- **Primary early outcome.** Buyer-confirmed need plus an agreed next validation step, reported with eligible opportunities worked as the denominator.
- **Guardrails and economics.** Unsupported claims, false relationships, stale evidence, rejected recommendations, and analyst cost per validated opportunity. A small pilot cannot establish reliable win-rate lift.

FIVE-MINUTE PRESENTATION ROUTE

Discover Ridgeway → inspect the demand mechanism → compare the research contribution → edit the capacity case → save a reviewed brief → apply the testing correction → show zero output benefit and stale review → explain the next validation step.

Pilot gates before expansion.

Confirm data rights and useful coverage; achieve acceptable decision quality; validate analyst economics; then consider live CRM context and broader account discovery. Autonomous outreach, general forecasting, and a universal market graph remain outside the first product.

SOURCES AND ASSUMPTIONS

A clear boundary between evidence and invention.

Primary public materials accessed 19 October 2026. Vendor pages support descriptions of positioning, not independent claims of accuracy or performance.

S1 **SalesPlay: Spot Opportunities Agent**

Existing discovery, offering-match, and business-case positioning.

S2 **Kris@Work**

GTM product positioning; no hands-on audit.

S3 **6sense: Account prioritization model**

Explainable prioritization and recommended actions.

S4 **Clay: Account Research Agents**

Official account research documentation.

S5 **Apollo: Go-to-Market Intelligence**

Official signals, context, and action positioning.

S6 **Gong: Revenue AI**

Official customer interaction and revenue AI positioning.

S7 **MarketsandMarkets: KnowledgeStore**

Research and market interconnection positioning; no licensed content accessed.

S8 **DOE: Strengthening America's Grid Supply Chain**

Published 10 Aug 2026; sector demand and manufacturing constraints.

S9 **LAE: Robot Stacker**

Vendor description of transformer core stacking equipment.

ASSUMPTIONS THAT TRAVEL WITH THE DEMO

All account names, seller details, process profiles, research samples, buyer confirmations, demand ranges, capacities, and economics are fictional. Public sources support the industry context only. The research comparison is illustrative; commercial demand, technical fit, costs, and budget remain unverified.